



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Riverstone Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.riverstoneclassicalacademy.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Riverstone Classical Academy (Bradenton, FL 34209) presents a compact, Christ-centered, classically oriented K–8 program delivered through a hybrid private homeschooling model hosted by Gulf Coast Church. The school explicitly anchors its mission in classical education—grammar, logic, and rhetoric—while emphasizing virtue, character formation, and a Christian worldview. Public materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendental goods, the living curriculum role of faculty, and a deep partnership with parents as co-teachers. Great Books, the Great Conversation, Latin, and history-centric integration appear as core curricular anchors. The school's public statements consistently describe a formation-oriented aim (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) rather than a sole workforce-preparation aim, and they foreground parent involvement, communal worship, and a shared moral framework.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- Category-by-category at-a-glance:
 - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
 - Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes: - The keyword analysis draws on the school's public materials (About Us, Enrollment/Handbooks, and blog-like content showing mission, pedagogy hints, and family partnerships) and maps them to the Positive/Negative keyword indicators from the classical-literature lexicon. From the classical-education lexicon, Riverstone's materials align strongly with the Positive Keywords across all six categories, with minimal to no explicit Negative signals observed in the public materials. Key terms consistently appearing include: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy/morning prayer; Great Books; Great Conversation; grammar, logic, rhetoric; scholé (contemplative/well-ordered rest), wonder; living/mentoring faculty; collaboration with parents as co-teachers; and explicit parental partnership and visitation openness. - Evidence and keyword mappings draw from the public-facing pages and documents, including statements that: - affirm a Christ-centered Christian worldview and daily prayer (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations) , □filecite□turn14□ - describe formation of virtue and wisdom via truth, goodness, beauty (Purpose/Goal) , - present grammar/-logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, and history as central curricular anchors (Curriculum) , - exhibit pedagogy components aligned with the classical tria doctrina and contemplative "Scholé" rhythms (Pedagogy) - show faculty as qualified teachers who employ classical methods and mentor relationships (Faculty) - emphasize a parental partnership as co-teachers and open invitations for parents to engage and participate (Parents & Community)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials consistently frame Riverstone as Christ-centered with a Christian worldview, including daily prayer in instruction and a Christian worldview for all curriculum. Examples include the explicit

Christ-centered framing and morning prayer emphasis in the school materials. □filecite□turn14□ - The project and curriculum descriptions emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent real goods, aligning with transcendental realism and theological grounding. See the stated purpose of classical Christian education and the Great Books emphasis.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: Christ-centered, Christian worldview, morning prayer, truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy/worship, reverence, wonder. - Negative keywords observed: None identified in the public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral language in these public elements).

Why this rating - The school's foundational language centers on a sacred, theologically anchored education, embracing virtues and transcendentals, and integrating liturgical/community worship into education. This matches CLASSICAL alignment for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission/purpose is described in terms of formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere workforce preparation; the Great Conversation and Great Books framing are emphasized, alongside the triad truth, goodness, beauty, and the telos of human flourishing. - The Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and the Threefold Trivium underpin the goal structure of formation and high-minded aims, not just job-readiness.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, liberal education/paideia, scholé, Great Conversation, human flourishing, soul craft. - Negative keywords observed: None observed in public materials (no explicit emphasis on workforce-preparation or 21st-century skills in the sense of "job-ready" language).

Why this rating - Riverstone's stated aims center on formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom in the classical sense, anchored by truth, goodness, and beauty, which aligns with CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials explicitly describe the classical liberal arts model, including grammar, logic, and rhetoric as the core; Latin study; Great Books and the Great Conversation; and history integrated through the curriculum. - The curriculum emphasizes history content within the curriculum (not just social studies), and a strong Great Books emphasis; Great Books and primary sources appear as anchors for the Great Conversation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin, history/Western civilization, liberal arts, classical languages. - Negative keywords observed: None clearly present in public materials (no explicit "social studies replacement," STEM-first framing, or project-led dominance in the core curriculum is stated publicly; there is some enrichment in STEM-like areas, but not framed as a core curriculum replacement).

Why this rating - The explicit three-stage curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, and Latin/history emphasis strongly align with classical curriculum norms. The public materials strongly reflect the classical curriculum lexicon.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The grammar stage is described as memory-based, with songs/chanting to deepen memory, which is a hallmark of classical pedagogy. The materials discuss memorization via songs, chants, and rhymes in the grammar stage. - The upper grades are described as evolving toward logic and rhetoric and the possibility of seminars or discussions; the public materials describe a classical, collaboratively structured pedagogy with a focus on memory-work and contemplative aspects (Scholé).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: grammar, logic, rhetoric, memorization, songs/chanting, memory work, Socratic/seminars, scholé, contemplation, wonder, debate, oratory, singing, chanting, recitation, narrative/narration. - Negative keywords observed: There is no explicit emphasis on exclusively project-based or experiential learning as the sole method; the enrichment programs exist but do

not dominate the core approach in the public materials. The lexicon's negative signals (e.g., project-based-dominant, experiential learning focus) are not clearly evidenced as the core pedagogy in RCA materials.

Why this rating - The explicit pedagogical emphasis on grammar/logic/rhetoric, memorization, and a potential for Socratic/seminar-style engagement (in line with classical pedagogy) supports CLASSICAL. The presence of contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) further supports a classical pedagogy alignment.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states it hires qualified teachers who will incorporate classical methods and provide meaningful coursework, with mentoring relationships between teachers and students. This is explicit in the "Collaborative Model – School Role" language. - The materials describe the faculty as part of the living curriculum and emphasize mentoring relationships, collegial culture, and character formation. The "Collaborative Model" language positions teachers as the core, with "living curriculum" implications.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: qualified teachers, classical teaching methods, mentoring relationships, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as living curriculum, collegial culture. - Negative keywords observed: none observed in public materials (no explicit "facilitators on the side" or non-classical credentialing language is evident).

Why this rating - Riverstone's public messaging centers teachers as the core of the educational experience, with a focus on classical pedagogy, mentoring, and a shared standard—consistent with CLASSICAL faculty expectations in the classical education rubric.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a collaborative model with parents as co-teachers and the primary educators of their children; it presents a covenant-like partnership with parents, including parent conferences and open communication with teachers. The parent role section is explicit. - The public materials indicate parent formation opportunities and a community-inclusive atmosphere, including open access to school visits and parent involvement as a core feature of the model. The materials describe a family-centered, liturgical, and participatory community approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation (book studies, gatherings), open campus, family involvement, home study days, parent covenant. - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in public materials (no consumer-only language, no minimal parental involvement; the public materials consistently frame parents as integral to the educational model).

Why this rating - The public materials strongly emphasize parental partnership, family formation, and a participatory community, matching the CLASSICAL pattern for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment - All six categories scored CLASSICAL. Public materials consistently reflect classic elements (great books, trivium, virtue formation, Christian worldview, collaborative parental partnership, and a living-faculty-centered model). The aggregate result is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable for a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation, as the school already achieves CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. No needle-moving changes are required to reach CLASSICAL on the rubric.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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